

Balance — User Guide for Judges

Balance helps a student whose plan no longer fits the day. It shows the overload, compares safe ways to fix it, changes nothing until the student confirms, and can undo every confirmed change.

Time needed: about 12 minutes. **Help needed:** none.

Quick path

Step	Page	What you will do	Time
1	—	Install the app, sign in and read the short introduction	2 min
2	TODAY	See a 2-hour overload, the day's time and tasks, and five workload bars	2 min
3	QUESTS	Open the two tasks behind the overload	1 min
4	COUNCIL	Compare options and confirm a plan	2 min
5	COUNCIL	Undo the plan from Plan history	1 min
6	SANCTUARY	Protect 30 minutes of rest from a suggested free time, then remove it	2 min
7	JOURNEY	Read the weekly summary and the achievement wall	1 min
8	PROFILE	Optional: sound, reminders and overload alerts	1 min

Before you start

You need	Where to get it
An Android phone (Android 8.0 or later) with internet, set to Malaysia time	—
The Balance app	Latest release → download <code>app-release.apk</code>
The judge account email and password	In our submission form. They are never stored in this repository.
The sample date	Sunday 1 November 2026 (also in our submission form).

The bottom bar has five pages: **TODAY**, **QUESTS**, **COUNCIL**, **SANCTUARY**, **JOURNEY**. Each page shows a practical name with a game-style label beside it, for example *Workload Overview* · *World Status*. Your profile is the round icon at the top right.

1. Install and sign in

1. On the phone, open the release link and download `app-release.apk`.
2. Open the downloaded file. If Android asks, allow installing apps from this source, then tap **Install**.
3. Open **Balance**, enter the judge email and password, and tap **Sign in**.
4. A three-page introduction appears the first time: **Detect**, **Decide**, **Recover and reflect**. Tap **Next**, or **Skip** at any time. You can reopen it later in **Profile** → **How Balance works**.

You should then see the **TODAY** page. If a "Local preview" banner appears at the top, this is not the release build; reinstall from the release link.

2. See the overload (TODAY)

Today shows what matters first: whether the day fits, then the time and work behind it.

1. If today is not the sample date, use the **Previous day / Next day** arrows to open it.
2. The **Time capacity** card shows **5h planned** against **3h available** and a red **2h over** tag. Below it, **Capacity gap** says 120 minutes must be moved, reduced or recovered.
3. **Availability** shows the free time: **9:00 AM – 12:00 PM**. Under it, **Repeat for the next 6 days** copies a day's time to the coming days, and an empty day offers **Copy from** the previous day. On this shared judge account, please only look at these buttons, so the sample week stays the same for every judge.
4. **Planned tasks** lists the two tasks. Tap one to see why it counts on this day.
5. Scroll to **Workload Overview · World Status**: five bars in a fixed order, **Mental, Time, Physical, Social, Errands**. Bars without enough data say **Unknown**; Balance never treats missing data as zero. When the previous day also has a record, each bar shows its change since yesterday (▲ more pressure, ▼ less). The **Load** badge at the top of the page summarises the five bars.
6. Tap **How is this calculated?** for one line per bar explaining its score.
7. At the bottom, **Optional updates** holds Daily Review, Movement and Social. They add detail to the workload bars; skipping them has no penalty.

3. Look at the tasks (QUESTS)

The sample day has two study tasks:

Task	Length	When	Deadline
Judge demo: flexible report	3h	Scheduled 9:00 AM – 12:00 PM on the sample date	The next day, 5:00 PM
Judge demo: deadline work	2h	Not scheduled	The sample date, 5:00 PM

Together they need 5 hours, but only 3 hours are available.

- **Tap a task** to open its details: remaining time, deadline, category, flexibility and status, with an **Edit task** button.
- Each card shows its category (Study, Errand, Social, Exercise or Other), its flexibility and whether it is **Protected**. Protected commitments such as a work shift, family duty or sleep minimum are never moved to make a plan fit.
- Optional: tap +, then close the form. A new task cannot be saved without a category.

4. Compare and confirm a plan (COUNCIL)

1. Open **COUNCIL** and go to the sample date. The page says *Suggestions only. Nothing moves until confirmed*.
2. Read the suggested option. It moves **2 hours of the flexible report to the next day**, where 2 hours are free (9:00 – 11:00 AM) and the report's deadline is still met. Each option lists the **Cost**, what stays **Protected**, the **Room created**, and anything to **Check before confirming**.

3. Tap **Compare plans** to see the options and the capacity of every affected day.
4. Select the option and tap **Confirm selected plan**, then confirm in the final preview. A soft chime plays if sound effects are on.
5. The plan-updated screen lists the moved work. Tap **Return to Today**: the sample date now fits, and the next day shows the moved 2 hours.

5. Undo the plan (COUNCIL)

1. Open **COUNCIL** and tap the **Plan history** icon (clock) at the top right.
2. Open the plan marked **Confirmed** and tap **Undo this plan**.
3. Plan history now marks it **Undone**. On **TODAY**, the sample date is **2h over** again and the next day is free.

If the tasks were edited after confirming, Undo is refused with an explanation instead of overwriting the newer changes.

Please always undo your plan, so the sample day stays ready for the next judge.

6. Protect rest time (SANCTUARY)

Recovery time is optional. Balance only lets you protect time that is genuinely free, and it suggests that time for you.

1. Open **SANCTUARY** and tap **Add recovery time**.
2. The form lists free time as one-tap suggestions. The sample date is fully booked, so it shows **Next free time · Mon 2 Nov** with **9:00 AM – 11:00 AM · 2h free**, already selected as 9:00 – 9:30 AM. Choosing an activity is optional. Tap **Save**.
3. The slot appears as **Protected time**. Marking an activity done does not change any workload score: rest is not graded.
4. **Please remove the slot afterwards**: open its menu (:) → **Remove**. It occupies the free time that the Council plan in step 4 needs.

7. Weekly summary and achievement wall (JOURNEY)

1. Open **JOURNEY** and use the week arrows to reach the week of the sample date. Days without a record say **No record**; past scores are never invented.
2. Optional: tap **Add optional reflection**, write one sentence and tap **Save**. The **My reflections** icon (clock) at the top lists reflections from earlier weeks.
3. Scroll to **Achievements**: a wall of seven badges. Earned badges glow gold with their date; locked badges are dimmed with a lock. **Tap a badge** to see how to unlock it.
4. Your steps above can unlock **Safe Trade-off**, **Deadline Safety**, **Protected Rest** and **Reflection**. A newly earned badge is celebrated once with an animation and a chime. Each badge is awarded once per account, so some may already be unlocked if another judge used this account first.
5. **Team Coordination** stays **Locked**. It needs shared tasks, which are planned for a later version.

There are no streaks, rankings or penalties for skipping.

8. Sound, reminders and alerts (PROFILE, optional)

1. Tap the round profile icon at the top right.

2. **Sound effects** (on by default) and **Relaxing background music** (off by default) can be switched here. All audio is original to Balance.
3. **Reminders and alerts** holds deadline reminders and **Overload alerts**: a notification the evening before a day with more planned work than available time. Both are off by default and ask for notification permission when turned on.
4. **How Balance works** reopens the introduction.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
"Could not connect" with Try again	Check the internet connection, then tap Try again . Data already on screen stays visible.
The sample date is not 2h over	Check that you are on the sample date. If a plan is still confirmed, undo it in COUNCIL → Plan history .
Times look several hours off (for example availability at 1:00 AM)	Set the phone to Malaysia time (Settings → System → Date & time → automatic time zone), then reopen Balance.
Council shows No Feasible Plan	A recovery slot may be occupying the next day. Remove it in SANCTUARY (step 6.4).
No sound	Check Profile → Sound effects and the phone's media volume.
Sign-in fails	Check the email and password from the submission form for typing errors.
"Can't install app"	Uninstall any earlier Balance test build first, then install again.

What Balance does not claim

- Scores describe recorded planning data. Balance is not a medical, diagnostic or mental-health tool.
- Android is the supported platform. iOS has not been tested on a device, and the web build is not part of this submission.
- Every task needs a deadline; a "No deadline" option is not available yet.
- The app is currently English-only. Bahasa Melayu and Chinese are planned.
- Shared tasks and the Team Coordination achievement are planned for a later version.